NewsBank inc.

State office - Here's how area Assembly races were playing out - Even longtime politics watchers may need a scorecard to follow state Assembly races that touch L.A. County, with new district borders, and even new districts altogether

June 9, 2022 | Whittier Daily News (CA)
Author: From staff reports | Section: News | 1423 Words
Page: 4
OpenURL Link

Even longtime politics watchers may need a scorecard to follow this year's state Assembly races in districts that touch Los Angeles County, with redistricting delivering new numbers, rejiggered footprints and some entirely new districts. Here's how Tuesday's primary elections played out:

District 34 >> In the High Desert, two prominent Republican legislators found themselves sharing the newly formed 34th Assembly District. Neither wanted to concede the seat. Primary voters got a choice between two incumbents — Assembly members Tom Lackey, R-Palmdale, and Thurston "Smitty" Smith, R-Apple Valley. They ended up within 41 votes of each other, with Democrat Rita Ramirez Dean about 800 behind in third place. The district now ranges from the top of L.A. County to the Nevada border.

District 39 >> Democrat Steve Fox, who served in the Assembly from 2012-14 before falling to Tom Lackey in the 36th District, ended up trailing the field and missing the runoff. Republican Paul Andre Marsh, a community services liaison, finished first with Juan Carrillo, a Palmdale City Council member, in second. Democrat Andrea Rosenthal, former political director for ex-Assemblywoman Christy Smith, finished third. The district has shifted during redistricting from the San Fernando Valley to include Lancaster, Palmdale and Victorville.

District 40 >> In this Republican-heavy district that now includes the northern San Fernando Valley, Santa Clarita and Castaic, GOP incumbent Suzette Martinez Valladares snagged 51% of the votes. Her likely runoff foe is nurse practitioner Pilar Schiavo, with 29%. Annie Cho, a businesswoman, finished third.

District 41 >> In this district that now spans Pasadena to LaVerne and Claremont out to Phelan and Wrightwood, five-term incumbent Democrat Chris Holden was unopposed.

District 42 >> Democratic Assemblywoman Jacqui Irwin grabbed 56% of the vote. GOP newcomer Lori Mills appears to be her runoff opponent. Ted Nordblum finished third in this district that roams up the coast from Bel-Air to Calabasas and Thousand Oaks. Irwin took the early lead, but her foes were neck-and-neck for second.

District 43 >> In this San Fernando Valley district that includes San Fernando, Sylmar, Pacoima and Panorama City, no one is opposing Assemblywoman Luz Maria Rivas.

District 44 >> In this Burbank-area district, redistricting pushed two-term Democratic Assemblywoman Laura Friedman out of her 43rd District, to face Republican business owner Barry Jacobsen in the newly drawn 44th. Friedman got nearly 70% of the votes in what could be a preview of November.

District 46 >> Democratic Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel finished first over Republican Dana Caruso, a retired educator — 62% to 37% — in the race to represent Woodland Hills, Warner Center, Canoga Park and Reseda. They will line up again in November.

District 48 >> Incumbent Democrat Blanca Rubio was unopposed in her bid to continue to represent such areas as West Covina, Baldwin Park, Glendora and Azusa.

District 49 >> It's a rematch. Back in February, Democrat Mike Fong defeated Republican Burton Brink in a special election after former Democrat Assemblyman Ed Chau was appointed an L.A. County Superior Court judge. The

district includes 10 cities in the San Gabriel Valley including El Monte and Monterey Park. Brink lost to Chau in 2018 and 2020. Fong won big Tuesday, but will see Brink again in November.

District 51 >> In this district that sprawls from Santa Monica to Griffith Park, Democratic newcomers Louis Abramson (38%), a scientist, and Rick Chavez Zbur (62%) a civil rights attorney who led early and large early Tuesday, will square off anew in the general election.

District 52 >> Democratic Assemblywoman Wendy Carrillo, who earned 51% of the vote, will race against fellow Democrat Mia Livas Porte in her bid to represent an L.A.-area footprint that includes Glendale, Silver Lake and Echo Park. Republican Gia D'Amato finished third.

District 53 >> Democratic Assemblyman Freddie Rodriguez (61%) topped Republican Toni Holle (39%), whom he defeated in 2018 and 2020. They will meet again in November in the race for this district, which straddles L.A. and San Bernardino counties, includes Pomona and Ontario.

District 54 >> In this district that now zig-zags from L.A.'s Koreatown to Commerce and Montebello, incumbent Democrat Miguel Santiago is unopposed.

District 55 >> Culver City sits in the center of this district, which also includes Leimert Park and Century City. Democratic Assemblyman Isaac Bryan won a special election last year in District 54 to replace Sydney Kamlager-Dove, who jumped over to the state Senate via special election and is now running for Congress in the 37th District. Bryan (82%) topped GOP newcomer Keith Cascio (17%), a software developer, to set up a rematch.

District 56 >> Democratic Assemblywoman Lisa Calderon (57%), who won in the 57th Assembly District in 2020, will face Republican Jessica Martinez (31%), a Whittier City Council member, in November. Republican Natasha Serrano, a businesswoman, finished third in this redrawn district that includes Pico Rivera, Whittier and La Puente.

District 57>> In this district that loops from downtown L.A. through much of South L.A., Democratic Assemblyman Reginald Jones-Sawyer is unopposed.

District 61 >> A new face will represent this district as redistricting and the sudden resignation of Autumn Burke from the old 62nd District leave an area that includes Inglewood, Venice and Hawthorne without an incumbent. Lawndale Mayor Robert Pullen-Miles and Democrat Tina Simon McKinnor, a nonprofit director, face one another in a runoff to serve out only the short remainder of Burke's term, until Dec. 4. Concurrently — and confusingly for many — Pullen-Miles, McKinnor, and fellow Democrats Angie Reyes English, a Hawthorne City Council member, and Nico Ruderman, Venice Neighborhood Council member, will take on James Spencer, a Republican from Inglewood, to serve in the new 61st District for a full two years. Pullen-Miles (37%) and McKinnor (30%) jumped in front early and never looked back.

District 62 >> Democratic incumbent Assemblyman Anthony Rendon (now representing the 63rd District, before the remapping due to redistricting) has defeated his opponent, fellow Democrat Maria Estrada, twice before. Regardless of Tuesday's outcome in this heavily Democratic Southeast L.A.-area district that touches South Gate, Paramount, Bellflower and Lakewood, Rendon likely faces a battle for his powerful role as Assembly speaker in Sacramento. Salinas Democrat Robert Rivas announced last month that 34 of the Assembly's 58 Democrats supported him to become speaker. But last week, Rendon and Rivas emerged from a six-hour closed-door caucus meeting to declare that Rendon would "remain as speaker for at least the rest of this legislative session." It's unclear now when — and if — Rivas will succeed Rendon. Rendon (65%) will see Estrada (35%) again in the fall.

District 64 >> This newly drawn Southeast-L.A. District including Downey, Norwalk and La Mirada will send a new member to the Assembly due to redistricting. Republican Raul Ortiz Jr. takes on an array of Democrats including Downey Mayor Blanca Pacheco, Cudahy Mayor Elizabeth Alcantar, Norwalk-La Mirada Unified School District Board Member Roberto Cancio, La Habra City Council member/former Mayor Rose Espinoza and Norwalk Vice Mayor Ana Valencia. Ortiz (36%) will take on Pacheco (23%) in the fall.

District 65 >> Post-redistricting, Democratic Assemblyman Mike Gipson, who led early, took aim at a newly drawn district that will include his current home base of Compton — but less of Carson — as well as Wilmington and much of the Port of L.A. area. Gipson (71%) will face Dubai-born Fatima Iqbal-Zubair (29%) in November.

District 66 >> Three-term Democratic incumbent Al Muratsuchi (59%) will enjoy a rematch with Republican George Barks (41%), a former Hermosa Beach councilman and mayor, in this race to represent the Beach Cities, Torrance and the Palos Verdes Peninsula communities.

District 67 >> This redrawn zone will straddle L.A. and Orange counties and encompass Artesia, Cerritos, Cypress, Buena Park and Fullerton, much like the current 65th District, where Sharon Quirk-Silva is the incumbent. In the 67th, Quirk-Silva (46%) will face Republicans Soo Yoo (40%), president of the ABC Unified School District's board in the fall. Also on the ballot: Democrat Paramvir "Param" Brar and Republican Sou Moua, who previously ran for Congress in California's 47th District.

District 69 >> Four Democrats square off to represent the newly redrawn 69th District and essentially become the successor to longtime Assemblyman Patrick O'Donnell. The district covers almost all of Long Beach, as well as Signal Hill and most of Carson. O'Donnell, the Long Beach Democrat who has represented the area as the 70th District assemblyman for eight years, decided not to run. Long Beach Councilman Al Austin and businessman Josh Lowenthal, a son of Rep. Alan Lowenthal, face county Democratic Central Committee member Janet Foster and nurse practitioner Merry Taheri. If the results hold up after updates, Lowenthal (45%) will face Austin (26%) in the fall. Foster finished third with 20%.

(c) 2022 Whittier Daily News. All rights reserved. Reproduced with the permission of Media NewsGroup, Inc. by NewsBank, Inc.

- **Citation (apa Style)**
  staff reports, F. (2022, June 9). State office Here's how area Assembly races were playing out - Even longtime politics watchers may need a scorecard to follow state Assembly races that touch L.A. County, with new district borders, and even new districts altogether. *Whittier Daily News (CA),* p. 4. Available from NewsBank: Access World News – Historical and Current: https://infoweb.newsbank.com/apps/news/document-view?p=WORLDNEWS&docref=news/18A871575960D380.